

Jony's Journey to the Crystal of Eternal Life

By

Kaelan Carlson

based on a true story

@Kaelan Carlson
Productions

kaelancarlsonproductions@gmail.
com

INT. KITCHEN - MORNING

PANS IN.

Jonny is eating breakfast with his brother (Steven) and mom (Linda), When his mom says.

LINDA

I read in the paper this morning, a big surprise announcement from the metropole at 10:27a.m. in the town square, Carrel heard from her sister it might involve a reward.

JONNY

why so specific?

STEVEN

Reward for tricks, like a puppy.
(Steven jokes)

Jonny chuckles as he glances at the clock on the wall.

CLOSE UP ON CLOCK SHOWING: 9:24.

LINDA

They say the metropole's been planning this for months, A challenge open to everyone, can you imagine?

Steven rolls his eyes.

STEVEN

Yeah, probably some publicity stunt, You'll win a free tour of City Hall or something thrilling like that.

JONNY

Still... if there's a reward, it could be worth trying for.

Linda sighs, her gaze lingering on the crooked For Sale sign in the yard. A moment of silence follows, broken by the radio.

RADIO BROADCASTER

Stay tuned for the metropole's announcement, the challenge of the decade awaits!

Outside, birds scatter as the wind shifts Jonny quickly finishes his oatmeal.

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JONNY
Back in a bit.

he tells his mom, grabbing his jacket.

LINDA
Jonny, be careful!
(Linda calls.)

her voice fading behind the creak of the screen door.

EXT. TOWN SQUARE - MORNING

The streets buzzing with talk of the announcement, children darted between legs, and every window radio echoed.

RADIO BROADCASTER
The challenge of the decade...

Jonny weaves through the crowd toward the main square. Then something stops him.

AT A SMALL CAFÉ TABLE SAT A FOUR-FOOT-THREE HUMANOID TORTOISE IN A FADED RED PONCHO. HIS SHELL BORE INTRICATE SWIRLS LIKE ANCIENT CARVINGS, AND HIS SHARP, STEADY EYES SEEMED TO NOTICE EVERYTHING.

He was sipping tea through a straw.

SAMUEL
Metropole nonsense again.
(he mutters.)

CLOSE UP, SETTING DOWN HIS CUP.

CLOSE UP, JONNYS LOOKS SHOCKED.

JONNY
Uh... did you say something?

The tortoise studies him and slowly smiles.

SAMUEL
Only that you look like someone about to do something foolishly brave.

JONNY
I'm just curious about the announcement, you know?

SAMUEL
Mmh, I do.

He leans back.

SAMUEL (CONT'D)
curiosity is the seed of destiny or
disaster. Dependant on your form.

He raises a stubby arm in a small bow.

SAMUEL (CONT'D)
Name's Samuel. Used to fight crime.

JONNY
What do you mean?

Jonny sits on the other chair.

SAMUEL
I'm 174, I Fought crime for 157 years
before Mother Time glued my gears. The
metropole's 97th anniversary parade is
Tuesday. Ninety-eight years ago, it
was just an idea for a more civil,
communal civilization, but that was a
façade, quickly claimed by greed and
control. The world before the
metropole was rough, barbaric, and
cruel no authority yet free.

JONNY
How exactly did you fight crime?

SAMUEL
Ancient hardcore Tai Chi, fourth
degree.

He replies swiftly, eyes twinkling.

SAMUEL (CONT'D)
So, Jonny, you think this 'challenge'
is your ticket to adventure?

Jonny blinks.

JONNY
How did you-.

Samuel raises a finger then taps his temple.

SAMUEL
Pretty powerful stuff, Fourth-degree
Tai Chinetic alignment can unlock
(MORE)

SAMUEL (CONT'D)
telekinetic abilities.

CLOSE UP, JONNY SMILES IN DISBELIEF.

Samuel stands, his shell gleaming.

SAMUEL (CONT'D)
Listen, boy. The metropolises challenge
promises gold, fame, maybe even your
own property. But those aren't
happiness. Not really.

Jonny's smile fades.

JONNY
Then what is?

Samuel chuckles.

SAMUEL
That's the real challenge.

Bells chime in the distance, 10:27. Horns blare across the
town square, a grand, patriotic melody that quiets the
chatter.

The static of a microphone fills the air, then a cheerful,
slightly distorted voice speaks.

JERMY
Good morning, people of the HQ! I'm
Jeremy, from the Department of
Security and Public Unity.

The crowd murmurs.

JERMY (CONT'D)
In just three days, we mark a historic
day, the metropole's 97th year of
peace, progress, and participation. To
celebrate, the metropole Council
presents... The Challenge of the Decade!

A mechanical trumpet sounds – be-da-daana!

JERMY (CONT'D)
This challenge is open to all
citizens! We need one brave
participant to retrieve the Crystal of
Eternal Life – its location hinted at
(MORE)

JERMY (CONT'D)
by an anonymous source.

The voice pauses, then recited a riddle.

JERMY (CONT'D)
Beyond the borders where silence hums,
In the forest of mirrors where the
river runs, Lies what time itself
cannot bind, The crystal that cheats
both death and mind.

The crowd murmurs.

JERMY (CONT'D)
The winner, will receive honor,
fortune, and a wish granted by the
metropole Council! Any wish, fulfilled
by decree. Citizens, prepare
yourselves for glory, discovery, and
service to the metro pal! That's The
Challenge of the Decade!

The crowd erupts in applause, though uncertainty lingering on
some faces.

As the crowd disperses, Samuel remains still, his gaze
distant.

Jonny turns to him.

JONNY
Did you hear that? The Crystal of
Eternal Life! It's real?

Samuel sips the last of his tea and sighs.

SAMUEL
Real enough, But every truth the
metropole speaks carries a shadow.

JONNY
What do you mean?

SAMUEL
The Crystal isn't theirs to claim. It
predates the metropole, predates
civilization itself. If they get it,
they'll never let the world breathe
free again.

He leans forward.

SAMUEL (CONT'D)

That's why you must go beyond the borders, Jonny. Find it before they do.

JONNY

Me? Why me?

SAMUEL

Because, you still believe. You haven't been tamed by comfort or fear.

Jonny looks down.

JONNY

My mom... she must sell our house. My brother's too young to understand, I can't just leave them they need me.

Samuel's tone softens.

SAMUEL

Every hero says that before they begin. But what you seek out there might be the very thing that saves them.

Jonny hesitates, then in a whispering tone.

JONNY

If I go, I'd have to come back. For them.

SAMUEL SMILES, SLOW AND KNOWING.

SAMUEL

Then that's your promise, Go beyond the borders, bring back the Crystal, and return home. For them.

The tortoise rises, his shell glowing in the morning sun.

SAMUEL (CONT'D)

I'll meet you at the edge of the HQ at sundown. Bring only what you can carry, and your courage.

Jonny nods, heart pounding, As he turned toward home, he glanced back, Samuel was already gone.

JONNY
Herbal essence?
(he whispers.)

EXT. CITY BORDER LAND - EVENING

The sun dipped behind the city walls as Jonny reached the edge of the HQ. Samuel sat on a stone by the old gate, his shell glowing in the orange light.

SAMUEL
You came.

Samuel smiles.

Jonny nods.

JONNY
Couldn't leave without saying goodbye.

Samuel rummages through his satchel and pulls out a folded purple poncho that shimmers in the dusk.

SAMUEL
This belonged to my old partner, a humanoid rat named Korbin. He left years ago to go teach ancient ninja practices in the sewers. Said peace was found in quiet places.

Jonny touches the fabric.

JONNY
It's... warm.

SAMUEL
It carries his spirit, Wear it, and you'll gain his speed, balance, and silence. But remember – it amplifies whatever's in your heart.

Jonny hesitates, then slips it on. The cloth hugs him perfectly, glowing faintly before settling still.

JONNY
How do I look?

Samuel chuckles.

SAMUEL
Like a brave fool, The best kind.

Jonny grins, tightening the clasp.

JONNY

Then I guess it's time.

Jonny nods once more and steps into the fading light. The purple poncho rippling behind him as the tortoise watches silently.

SAMUEL

Walk well, my boy.
(shouts.)

Samuel sips his herbal tea, quiet and steady.

LONG SHOT OF JONNY GOING OVER THE HORIZON.

FADES OUT.

EXT. MAINLAND BRIDGE - NIGHT

Jonny reaches the old stone bridge marking the end of the metropole's HQ land.

Beyond it, the Forest of Mirrors looms, trees glinting like shards of glass under the moonlight.

But the bridge isn't empty. Slumped against the railing sits a massive troll, moss-covered and grumbling, with a chipped badge: "Tyler, official Bridge Guardian."

TYLER

Halt!, No travellers past sundown
without metropole clearance! Rules are
rules.

JONNY

Please, I just need to cross—

TYLER

No exceptions, The last one who tried
went swimming' with the stones. Not
too pretty.

SAMUEL

(voice over)
it amplifies whatever's in your heart.

He grips the poncho, It shimmers faintly, Pulling the hood up, he felt lighter, soundless, breath softens.

Tyler yawns, scratching his head.

TYLER
Strange breeze tonight...

Jonny steps carefully, each movement silent. The poncho cloaked him like a shadow.

He slips past the troll, who only blinked at the rustle.

TYLER (CONT'D)
damn climate change.
(he mutters.)

On the other side, Jonny lowers his hood, The poncho dims, he looks back, Tyler was snoring beneath the lantern's light.

Jonny smiles.

JONNY
Thanks, Korbin.
(he whispers, patting the fabric.)

EXT. INNER FORRET - DAWN

PANS IN.

THE FOREST OF MIRRORS, DARK AND GLIMMERING.

He took his first step inside, The moment Jonny did, the air shifts. Trees shimmering with glassy veins, the path soft with moss and silver dust. A low hum began to sound.

REFLECTIONS FLICKER AROUND HIM, HIS MOTHER POURING COFFEE, SUNLIGHT SPILLING THROUGH THE WINDOW, HIS BROTHER LAUGHING WITH CRUMBS OF TOAST ON HIS FACE. EACH IMAGE RIPPLING, FADING WHENEVER HE BLINKS.

JONNY
Why are you showing me this?

The trees swaying, the hum growing more noticeable and loud.

INDISTINCT VOICE
Why do you seek the crystal? For
glory...or riches?

JONNY
I don't want riches, I just want my
family to be okay. I want to go home
and not feel like everything's
slipping away.

The forest dims in response. Then, movement a figure ahead. Jonny stops. The poncho pulses around his shoulders.

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JONNY (CONT'D)

Samuel?

(he calls softly.)

The figure turns, then vanishes into the mist.

Jonny follows, heart racing.

The hum cuts out. Moss crunches beneath his boots as a shimmer flickers between the trunks. Drawing up his hood, the poncho cloaks him in shadow.

A deep, calm voice says.

JEREMIAH

You can stop hiding now, young traveler. The forest knew you were coming.

Jonny stumbles and looks up, The figure turns, a humanoid panda with golden eyes and a faint scar across his snout.

JEREMIAH (CONT'D)

I'm Jeremiah, guardian of the eastern mirrors,
(he said, bowing.)

JEREMIAH (CONT'D)

I once walked the old kingdoms as a Kung Fu practitioner. The ancient ways still live through me.

JONNY

Maybe you can help me. I'm searching for the Crystal of Eternal Life.

Jeremiah's gaze sharpens.

JEREMIAH

It lies deep within the forest, in the center of the mirrored lakes. But you are not the only one who desires it. A dragon guards the crystal, bound to it since ancient times. Only those with true purpose can approach.

JONNY

I don't want it for power. I just... need it to save my family.

Jeremiah studies him, then nods.

JEREMIAH

Your heart speaks truth. But the path
is perilous. The metropole's Lockdown
Squad has crossed the forest's edge.
When they come, they will burn all in
their way.

Jonny's eyes widen.

JEREMIAH (CONT'D)

You will not go alone,
(he says firmly.)

JONNY

thank yo-

JEREMIAH

I will guide you, you will call me
sinsay, But promise me this when the
dragon wakes, do not fight fire with
fire, Listen, The answer may not be
what you expect.

Jonny nods.

JONNY

I promise, sinsay.

Jeremiah smiles.

JEREMIAH

Good. Then our path begins.

Jonny and Jeremiah leave in silence.

EXT. FOREST - MORNING

Their reflections stretching across pools of still water.

Ahead, the trees thin, the quite shatters.

A low, mechanical hum grew sharp and loud. From the mist,
four Lockdown Droids emerge, tall and black-plated, arms
unfolding into hissing flamethrowers.

DROID

Targets located nearby, eliminate
perpetrators, Burn the rest.

JONNY

Sinsay they found us.

Jeremiah steps forward, staff glowing faintly.

JEREMIAH

Stay behind me, These machines know
only destruction, But the forest knows
me.

Flames erupt, but Jeremiah strikes the air with his palm. The fire bends and dissolves into sparks. He moves like water, his staff cracking through metal, splitting the nearest droid. Another lung, spewing fire, but he spun, striking with a single paw. The machine fell still.

Jonny's poncho pulses with energy. His vision sharpened, he saw the droids' movements before they struck. His body felt lighter, faster.

JONNY

Korbin's gift
(he whispers.)

.

He dashes, half invisible. A droid swings at empty air. Jonny reappears behind it, kicking through its fuel line. The explosion lites the mirrored lakes, scattering reflections across the trees.

When the smoke cleared, the last droid collapsed, sparking. Jeramiah lowered his staff calmly.

JEREMIAH

You learned quickly.

Jonny exhales.

JONNY

I didn't even think. The poncho just...
moved with me.

JEREMIAH

That is its way.

He steps onto the first glassy stone.

JEREMIAH (CONT'D)

Come, The heart of the mirrors lies
beyond this shore.

Jonny nods, catching his breath they advance.

EXT. MIRROR LAKES CENTER - AFTERNOON

Jonny and Jeremiah reached the center of the Mirror Lakes. Suspended above a stone pedestal floated the Crystal of Eternal Life, its light pulsing like a heartbeat. Visions of his mother, brother, and home flickered in his mind.

JONNY

I have to do this.
(he whispers.)

The ground shakes, From the shadows, a massive dragon rises.

JEREMIAH

The guardian.
(he murmurs.)

Jonny pulls up his purple poncho, vanishing. Step by step, he creeps toward the crystal. The dragon sniffs the air.

He grabs a rock and tosses it across the cave. The clang echoed the dragon spun, unleashing a torrent of flame. Seizing the moment, Jonny lunges and snatches the crystal. Its light dims into his hands. He sprints back to Jeremiah, lowering his hood.

JONNY

Got it.

Jeremiah nods with pride.

JEREMIAH

Then we must move before it learns
your tricks.

Together, they vanish into the mirrored mist, the crystal safe in Jonny's knapsack.

FADES OUT.

EXT. FORREST- NIGHT

The forest light shifts by the time Jonny and Jeremiah reaches the bridge.

The Crystal of Eternal Life rests safely in his bag. Jeremiah standing beside him, staff across his shoulders, calm and steady.

JEREMIAH

This is where we part, The path ahead
belongs to you now.

JONNY

I couldn't have done this without you,
sinsay.

JEREMIAH

Perhaps, But the courage was always
yours.

Jonny bows.

JONNY

Thank you... for everything.

JEREMIAH

Go on, Before the forest changes its
mind.

Jeremiah bows, then Jonny starts to walk away and turns to
look back but Jeremiah was already gone.

EXT. METROPOLE BRIDGE - DAWN

Jonny crosses slowly. Tyler, the troll, hunched at his post,
staring into the water. He glances up as Jonny passed and
gave a quiet nod.

By the time Jonny reaches the other side, the world felt
smaller, more familiar, Town streets glowing in the
moonlight.

INT. KITCHEN - MORNING

Opening the door to his house, he sniffs.

JONNY

tea?
(he whispers.)

There, at the kitchen table, sat Samuel, shell gleaming under
the lamp, chatting easily with linda.

SAMUEL

Ah, there you are, We were just
talking about you.

JONNY

You're here?

SAMUEL

I never miss a good ending, especially
when there's tea involved.

Jonny smiles, setting the crystal on the table. It glows across their faces like a quiet sunrise.

LINDA
It's... beautiful. What will you do with it?

Jonny sighs.

JONNY
I think someone else should have it.

Samuel raises an eyebrow.

SAMUEL
After all that trouble?

JONNY
It belongs to the world, not me.

EXT. METROPOLE BRIDGE - EVENING

Later that day, Jonny met Jeremiah by the bridge once more.

Handing him the crystal, its light reflects across their faces.

JONNY
Put it to good use.

JEREMIAH
You've chosen wisely,

Jeremiah nods.

JEREMIAH (CONT'D)
Not all heroes keep what they set out for, that's a mark of true adventure.

THE PANDA WATCHES AS JONNY DISAPPEARS INTO THE FOREST.

INT. KITCHEN - NIGHT

Jonny returns home to golden skies, Samuel was still there, sipping tea.

JONNY
the crystal's safe.

SAMUEL
who has it now?

JONNY
a worthy protector, guardian of the
eastern mirror's, sinsay jeremiah.
(he says proudly.)

CLOSE UP, LINDA'S PROUD.

CLOSE UP, SAMUEL'S PROUD.

SAMUEL
Your mother says things have been
rough,
(he smiles.)
I'll buy the house, On one condition.

Jonny blinks out of shock.

JONNY
Condition?

SAMUEL
Invite me over for tea now and then. I
do love this blend.

Jonny laughs.

JONNY
Deal.

Linda smiles, tears glimmering. The weight that had hung over
the family for months finally lifted.

Jonny and his mom embrace in a hug, Samuel smiling sipping
Linda's blend proud.

FADES OUT.

The end.